



Dark Secrets **Conspiracy Theories**

Comprehension Questions

1. What is a conspiracy theory?

2. What do conspiracy theorists believe was the motivation for faking the moon landing in 1969?

3. What do Flat Earthers believe the world looks like?

4. Name two popstars who are believed to have been secretly replaced.

5. How much did Denver International Airport cost to build?

6. Describe the strange work of art at Denver International Airport.

7. What is a Freemason?

8. Who is David Icke?



9. Why do conspiracy theorists believe the assassination of John F. Kennedy is not as it seems?

10. Who killed Lee Harvey Oswald, and why?

Extension

- Why do you think people believe in conspiracy theories?
- Are there any conspiracy theories you believe in? What are they, and why do you believe them?
- Do you think there is any harm in conspiracy theories?



Dark Secrets Conspiracy Theories

Comprehension - Answers

1. What is a conspiracy theory?

A theory that the “official” version of events told to the public is actually a lie and that the powers that be are lying or covering up facts to manipulate the population.

2. What do conspiracy theorists believe was the motivation for faking the moon landing in 1969?

They believe that America faked it in order to ‘win’ the Space Race.

3. What do Flat Earthers believe the world looks like?

Instead of being a sphere, it is a flat circle with the Arctic in the middle.

4. Name two popstars who are believed to have been secretly replaced.

Avril Lavigne and Paul McCartney.

5. How much did Denver International Airport cost to build?

\$4.8 billion.

6. Describe the strange work of art at Denver International Airport.

A 32-foot-high blue horse with red glowing eyes, nicknamed Blucifer, whose creator bled to death after a piece of the sculpture fell off and severed his artery during its construction.

7. What is a Freemason?

A member of a male-only secret society with a secret handshake and a large element of ritual, special symbols, clothing and ceremony.

8. Who is David Icke?

A former professional footballer who believes in the Illuminati and that the world is controlled by a race of alien reptiles who can shape-shift into human form and control humanity.

9. Why do conspiracy theorists believe the assassination of John F. Kennedy is not as it seems?

Because more shots were fired than the police claimed and the angle of the shot did not appear to come from where Oswald was standing. Oswald never confessed and was killed before the case could go to trial.

10. Who killed Lee Harvey Oswald, and why?

Nightclub owner Jack Ruby, in order to spare Mrs Kennedy from suffering through a trial.

Extension

- Why do you think people believe in conspiracy theories?

Answers could explore:

- the fact that people don't always understand science and prefer to believe their own version of events;
- that people take comfort in the fact someone is controlling them and they have no power over their destiny;
- that governments and people in power have sometimes been caught manipulating the truth, so the public no longer have any trust in them.



- Are there any conspiracy theories you believe in? What are they, and why do you believe them?

Answers should give a detailed explanation of why the student finds the theory convincing.

- Do you think there is any harm in conspiracy theories?

Answers should explore the impact that these theories can have on individuals (for example, causing distress to Avril Lavigne by claiming she is really dead) and the effect that they can have on public morale (trying to discredit the enormous amount of work that went into the moon landings, for example). Answers could also explore the idea that perhaps politicians do like to protect the public, by keeping details of the Kennedy assassination secret, for example, and whether or not there is ever an excuse for hiding the truth.